

AXEL RAFFENAUD

CHIEF REVENUE OFFICER | DEPUTY CEO | VP SALES EMEA

Targeting Executive Leadership Roles in High-Growth Scale-ups, Mid-Caps & International Tech Enterprises

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Accomplished Executive Director & Chief Revenue Officer with 20+ years of successful P&L leadership, commercial scaling, and business transformation across SaaS, Cloud ERP, IT Services, and Advisory sectors. Proven track record driving high-yield Go-to-Market strategies, expanding EMEA footprints, and executing complex corporate turnarounds. Expertise spans leading cross-functional teams up to 120 headcount, managing €5.5M+ P&Ls, building high-performing direct & partner sales engines, and advising C-Suite stakeholders through scale-up and restructuring phases. Recognized for aligning commercial execution with financial rigor, strategic governance, and organizational agility.

+275% ARR SAAS ARR GROWTH (€200K TO €750K)	4x Pipeline SALES EXPANSION & CRM OPTIMIZATION	350+ Accounts DIRECT ENTERPRISE CLIENTS SCALED	120 Headcount MAX ORGANIZATION MANAGED
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CORE EXECUTIVE COMPETENCIES

Executive Leadership:	P&L Management, General Management, Corporate Governance, Change Management, Turnaround Strategy, OKR/OGSM Frameworks, M&A Integration.
Revenue & Growth:	Go-to-Market (GTM) Strategy, Strategic Alliances, Channel Management, Enterprise Sales Execution, Account-Based Marketing (ABM), International Expansion.
Sales Methodologies:	MEDDIC, Challenger Sale, Value Selling, Solution Selling, Consultative B2B Selling, Complex Deal Structuring & Negotiation.
Tech Stack & Metrics:	SaaS, Enterprise Cloud ERP (Oracle NetSuite, SAP Business One), CRM (Salesforce, HubSpot, Pipedrive), BI, AI Tools Metrics: ARR, MRR, CAC, CLTV, NRR, Churn.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Chief Commercial Officer / Commercial & Development Director 09/2025 – 05/2026
IT SPIRIT — Cloud ERP Systems Integrator (Oracle NetSuite, SAP Business One) Lyon, France

- Scope: Executive Committee Member with full operational delegation over commercial strategy, sales force recruitment, CRM stack selection, and PME/ETI market expansion.
- Commercial Structuration & Scaling:** Designed and executed the GTM expansion roadmap for Cloud ERP (Oracle NetSuite, SAP Business One), HRIS, and BI solutions targeting mid-market (PME/ETI) accounts.
 - Sales Engine & Governance:** Re-architected sales compensation, key performance indicators (KPIs), and CRM tech stack, driving standardized value selling and margin optimization.
 - Strategic Alliances:** Established 10+ ecosystem partnerships across Financial Advisory, MOA Consultancies, Cybersecurity, and IT firms to accelerate deal origination in France and abroad.
 - Executive Certification:** Dual-certified under Oracle NetSuite SuiteLife program (SuiteWeek Sales & Demo/Delivery).

Chief Revenue Officer / VP Sales & Customer Success Europe 05/2022 – 09/2025
AIDAXIS — Enterprise B2B SaaS Digital Adoption Platform (DAP) Lyon, France

- Scope: Executive Committee Member leading Sales, Marketing, and Customer Success teams (10 FTEs) across European markets. Full P&L responsibility for European ARR.
- Top-Line Revenue Expansion:** Scaled European ARR from €200K to €750K in 3 years (+275% growth) by establishing enterprise GTM rigor and upselling tier-1 accounts.
 - Pipeline Quadrupling:** Expanded deal pipeline by 4x within 18 months through CRM refactoring, inbound/outbound sales enablement, and structured MEDDIC execution.
 - Ecosystem & Co-Selling:** Built 14 strategic alliances with global tech leaders (including Microsoft, CRM/ERP publishers, and major IT integrators), generating scalable co-selling revenue streams.
 - SaaS Economics Optimization:** Significantly reduced Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC) and Payback period while driving Net Revenue Retention (NRR) and Customer Lifetime Value (CLTV).

Chief Revenue Officer & Managing Partner (Co-Founder)

05/2018 – 05/2022

EAZYLANG — Translation Management B2B SaaS Platform

Lyon, France

- Scope: Board Member overseeing B2B commercial strategy, digital acquisition, strategic partnerships, and operations (8 FTEs).
- **Rapid Customer Acquisition:** Onboarded 350 direct corporate accounts within 24 months and built a network of 22,000 global linguists and specialized agencies.
 - **Strategic Alliances:** Established 60 key commercial partnerships in 18 months, expanding distribution and brand penetration across corporate ecosystems.
 - **Crisis Resilience & Monetization Pivot:** Restructured pricing models and subscription tiers during COVID-19, stabilizing MRR and protecting operating margins.
 - **Government Recognition:** Secured official accreditation under the French State "France Relance" program as an approved Translation Management Platform.

Chief Operating Officer & Head of Business Development

05/2014 – 10/2017

COHÉSION INTERNATIONAL — Organizational & HR Management Consulting

France

- Scope: Executive Director managing €5.5M P&L, 70 franchised senior consultants, and 24 junior associates across Sales, Marketing, and Consulting.
- **Corporate Transformation:** Led the strategic transition of the corporate business model from a traditional franchise structure to an agile cooperative network.
 - **Financial Growth:** Managed €5.5M P&L and generated +12% consolidated top-line growth over a 3-year transformation period.
 - **Governance & Operations:** Modernized sales governance, revamped service offerings, and streamlined multi-site operational delivery.

Managing Director & Executive Growth Consultant

01/2010 – 03/2015

AXEL RAFFENAUD CONSULTING GROUP — Management & Strategy Firm

Lyon, France

- Scope: C-Suite Advisory specializing in business strategy, restructuring, international development, and capital raising.
- **Turnaround & Scale-up Advisory:** Advised 24 executive teams across 12+ industries (Tech, Industrial, Luxury, Energy, Logistics, Retail) on GTM execution and scaling.
 - **Capital Raising:** Facilitated and secured over €2.0M in equity and debt financing for high-potential client expansion projects.
 - **Cross-Border Expansion:** Managed market entry and international setup projects across Ireland, Luxembourg, Belgium, Canada, Switzerland, and CEE regions.

Early Career Foundations (2000 – 2009)

France

- **CYFALY (Partner & VP Sales):** Managed transverse sales teams up to 120 business reps; tripled revenue pipeline; co-led €150K seed fundraising round.
- **VISIATIV (Senior Business Developer / Pre-Sales):** Originated and qualified 320+ enterprise IT & digital transformation projects.
- **KONICA MINOLTA / CAISSE D'ÉPARGNE / INSAVALOR:** Progressive sales, corporate banking, and technology transfer marketing roles.

EDUCATION, CERTIFICATIONS & GOVERNANCE

EDUCATION

- Master’s Degree in Marketing & International Business
- IDRAC Business School, Lyon (1999 - 2001)
- Higher National Diploma (BTS) — Agro-Industrial Sales
- SANDAR Institute, Limonest (1997 - 1999)
- Vocational Degree & Technical Certifications
- LEGTA & INTERFORA (1993 - 1997)

CERTIFICATIONS & LANGUAGES

- Oracle NetSuite Sales Certified (2025)
- Oracle NetSuite Demo & Delivery (2025)
- JCI Certified Trainer (2006)
- Occupational Risk & QVT Trainer (2015)

Languages: French (Native) | English (C1 - Executive / Business Negotiation) | Spanish (A2) | Russian (A2)

EXECUTIVE BOARD & COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP

- **President:** Regional Chamber of Management Consultants (FNCPC Rhône-Alpes) – Led regional consultancy governance (2012-2015).
- **Founder & President:** Club Affaires 69 — Built France's #1 business networking community on Viadeo (6,000+ C-level members) (2006-2011).
- **Board Member & Commission Co-President:** Junior Chamber International (JCI Lyon) (2006-2007).
- **Civic Service:** French Red Cross Volunteer (2003-2005) | French Navy Reserve Training (PMM) (1995-1996).